

PROFESSIONAL CONDUCT

The Loudoun County School Board expects all staff, as public employees, to recognize that they are in a position of public trust and are held to the highest standard of personal and professional conduct, serving as role models, influencing and shaping young lives, and representing the school division. It is the policy of the School Board to promote and foster work and educational environments that demonstrate the principles of respect, professionalism, civility, and inclusivity.

As stewards of the school division, employees are expected to convey these principles to students, parents, colleagues, and the school community through their actions and day-to-day activities.

A. Expectation of Professionalism. Employees are expected to perform all assigned job duties in accordance with performance standards and job-specific requirements (to include attendance-related policies, procedures, and guidelines). Employees are expected to conduct themselves professionally, to treat all individuals with dignity, respect, and civility, and to demonstrate a commitment to an inclusive, safe and supportive work and educational environment where individuals from diverse backgrounds work together to pursue the shared mission of the school division.

B. Commitment to Equitable Treatment. The Loudoun County School Board is committed to an equitable and inclusive work and educational environment for employees and students. Loudoun County Public Schools rejects behavior and language that denigrates or demeans individuals on the basis of actual or perceived race, national origin, ancestry, color, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity, pregnancy, childbirth or related medical conditions, marital status, age, religion, disability, genetic information, veteran status or any basis protected by law, recognizing that such behavior and language encourages discrimination, hatred, oppression, and violence. Employees are expected to support the school division's commitment to action-oriented equity and nondiscrimination practices through the performance of their job duties in order to promote respect, professionalism, civility and inclusivity for all persons.

C. Recognition of Appropriate Employee-Student Boundaries. Employees are expected to establish and maintain appropriate physical, social and emotional boundaries with students. All forms of contact and communication with students must be transparent, accessible to supervisors and parents, nonsexual, unambiguous in meaning, and professional in reference and content.

Nothing herein shall be construed to limit appropriate student-staff relationships such as friendships between families, friendships between children, membership in faith-based or civic-minded communities or any appropriate familial relationship of the employee.

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D. Reporting. Employees with supervisory responsibilities are expected to encourage professional, respectful, civil, equitable, nondiscriminatory and inclusive work and educational environments for employees and students, and to address issues of unprofessionalism. Employees and students who feel they have been subjected to conduct that may violate the expectations outlined within this policy, should notify their supervisor or appropriate school administrator, respectively, as outlined in Regulation 7560.

1. Employees must ensure they are following reporting requirements outlined in School Board policies. Additionally, any employee who becomes aware of sexual harassment by any means is obligated to immediately report it to their supervisor who will, in turn, report the matter to the Title IX Coordinator.

2. Employees should report violations of LCPS's commitment to equitable treatment and all forms of harassment and unlawful discrimination of students and staff to their immediate supervisor or principal.

E. Protected Speech. Employees of the school division must recognize that they are in a position of public trust. However, nothing in this policy or any other policy shall be interpreted as abridging an employee's First Amendment right to engage in protected speech or their right to a private life outside of their work responsibilities except as provided by law.

F. Provision Against Retaliation. Employees are prohibited from retaliating against an individual for raising concerns of potential violations of this policy. Individuals who knowingly make false complaints under this policy are subject to disciplinary action. Reasonable, good faith beliefs that this policy has been violated will not result in discipline if the concerns raised are later proven untrue.

Adopted: 10/10/72

Revised: 6/22/93, 4/26/16

Current Revision: 09/14/21

Legal Refs: Code of Virginia §§ [22.1-291.4](#), [22.1-276.01](#)

Cross Refs: Policy [7014](#), Environments Free From Harassment, Discrimination and Abuse, Policy [7016](#), Employment Complaints, Policy [7312](#), Evaluation of Licensed, Classified, and Administrative Staff, Policy [7530](#), Duty to Report Child Abuse and Neglect, Policy [7550](#) Drug- and Alcohol-Free Workplace, Policy [7560](#) Professional Conduct, Policy [7566](#), Employee Technology Acceptable/Responsible Use, Policy [8250](#), Bullying Prevention and Education, Duty to Report Sexual Harassment as provided by Title IX Regulations, [34 C.F.R. Part 106](#).